



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Japan. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's great that you've completed primary school—congrats! Since you're 16, fluent in Danish, and have a multicultural background, you're in a strong position to explore different educational and career paths. Here's a breakdown of the main options you have in Denmark after finishing *folkeskole* (primary/lower secondary school), and some advice to help you decide:

🎓 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

These prepare you for university.

Main types:

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** – General academic education, wide range of subjects. Good if you're interested in humanities, social sciences, or natural sciences.
- **HHX (Højere handelseksamen)** – Focus on business, economics, and languages. Great if you're interested in international business or management.
- **HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)** – Focus on science and technology. Ideal if you're into engineering, IT, or design.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen)** – A 2-year program for students who may prefer a shorter, more practical academic route to further education.

🟢 *Best for you if:* You think you might want to go to university later, and you're strong academically or want to keep doors open.

🔧 2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training, EUD)

Learn a trade while also getting education. You alternate between school and practical work.

Examples:

- Electrician, carpenter, chef, hairdresser, IT supporter, health care worker.

🟢 *Best for you if:* You want to start working sooner, learn by doing, or know you want a specific career.

✈️ 3. Kombinerede forløb & Internationale muligheder

Since you have a Japanese background, you might also consider:

- **IB (International Baccalaureate)** – An international high school program taught in English. Good if you might study or work abroad, or if you enjoy English.
 - **Efterskole or Højskole (1 year schools)** – Good for personal development, language skills, or exploring interests like art, sports, or travel before continuing.
 - **Japan-related studies or exchanges** – You could explore programs that include Japanese language or culture, or plan a future exchange/study program in Japan.
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So what should you consider?

Ask yourself:

1. **What subjects do I enjoy most?**
 2. **Do I like hands-on learning or academic work?**
 3. **Do I want to go to university eventually?**
 4. **Am I interested in international experiences (Japan or elsewhere)?**
 5. **Would I benefit from a “pause” year like efterskole to explore more?**
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My Recommendation (based on your background):

If you're unsure, **STX** is a safe and flexible choice, especially if you're good in a wide range of subjects and think university might be in your future. You can combine it with subjects like Japanese, international studies, or natural sciences depending on the school.

Alternatively, **IB** could be a great fit if you want a strong international education and are comfortable in English.

If you want time to grow personally and explore more of your identity and interests, consider doing **a year at an efterskole**, especially one focused on languages, creativity, or global perspectives.

If you'd like, I can help you find specific schools or programs near where you live in Denmark—or create a personalized plan based on your interests. Just let me know!